

Finance Decision Checklist for Non-Finance Managers

Use these ten questions before approving an investment, project, financing choice, partnership, or operating change. The checklist is designed to improve judgment, not to replace professional advice or a full financial review.

1

What value will this decision create?

Name the customer, operating, strategic, or financial value. Separate a useful outcome from a merely attractive activity.

Notes / evidence:

2

Which cash flows will actually change?

Compare the decision with the realistic alternative. Include opportunity cost, working capital, tax, maintenance, and exit cash flows.

Notes / evidence:

3

When will cash enter and leave the company?

Place major payments and receipts on a timeline. Mark the lowest cash point and the moment value is expected to arrive.

Notes / evidence:

4

What assumptions drive the result?

Identify the few assumptions that move the answer most: volume, price, timing, cost, adoption, financing, or execution capacity.

Notes / evidence:

5

What happens in the downside scenario?

State a plausible downside, not an imaginary catastrophe. Show the effect on cash, covenants, delivery, reputation, and future choices.

Notes / evidence:

FROM DOWNSIDE TO DECISION

6

Is the decision reversible?

Can the company stage, delay, test, resize, pause, sell, or exit? Name the next decision point and the evidence required there.

Notes / evidence:

7

What liquidity or financing constraints exist?

Check minimum cash, debt service, covenant headroom, refinancing dates, currency exposure, and access to emergency capacity.

Notes / evidence:

8

Who owns the risk?

Name who monitors the risk, who may change the plan, who may stop it, and who challenges the assumptions independently.

Notes / evidence:

9

How will performance be measured?

Use a small set of measures that connect learning, operations, cash, risk, and value. Check what behaviour each measure may reward.

Notes / evidence:

10

What evidence would change the decision?

Write the threshold for invest, stage, delay, or reject before the meeting. A useful recommendation states how it can be proven wrong.

Notes / evidence:

FINAL RECOMMENDATION

INVEST	STAGE	DELAY	REJECT

Decision owner: _____ Review date: _____ Evidence that would reopen the decision:
